



Course Evaluations Spring 2025, period 1

Course Director Report for 5329 Inequality, Household Behavior, & the Macroeconomy



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Created **Thursday, March 27, 2025**



Courses Audience: 25
Responses Received: 12
Response Ratio: 48.00%

Report Comments

The content of this report is intended for the course director. Please be cautious when discussing the results and do not distribute the report outside the School. The Stockholm School of Economics is committed to ensuring the protection of personal data and the integrity of students and employees.

All ratings are on a scale from 1 to 7, where 1 is “disagree strongly” and 7 is “agree strongly”.

The total teacher average is calculated regardless of the number of responses to each question. This means that the three teacher-related questions have the same weight.

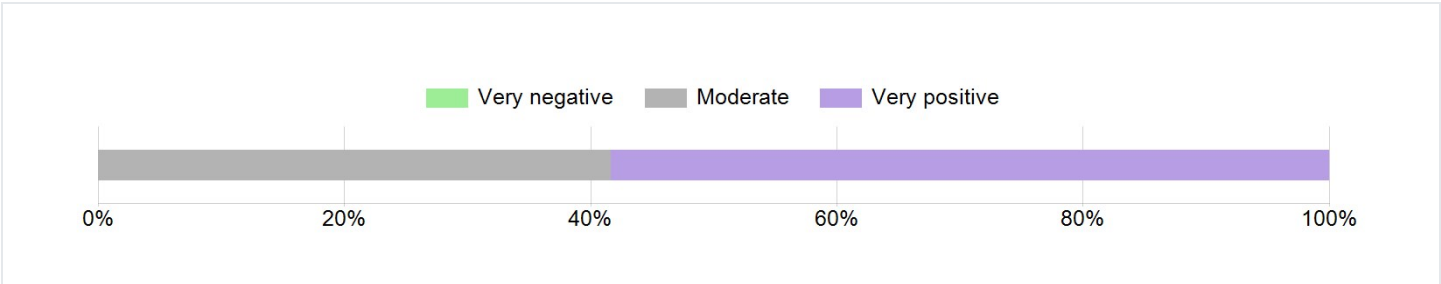
N.B. If there are course feedback surveys closing after the end of the current study period, this report might be updated.

For CIVICA courses, only students registered in SSE's student information system were surveyed.

If this report is for a mandatory course in one of SSE's programs, this report will also be shared with the program director directly.

Please contact SSEquality@hhs.se if you have any questions.

Course Satisfaction (scale distribution)



Course Satisfaction

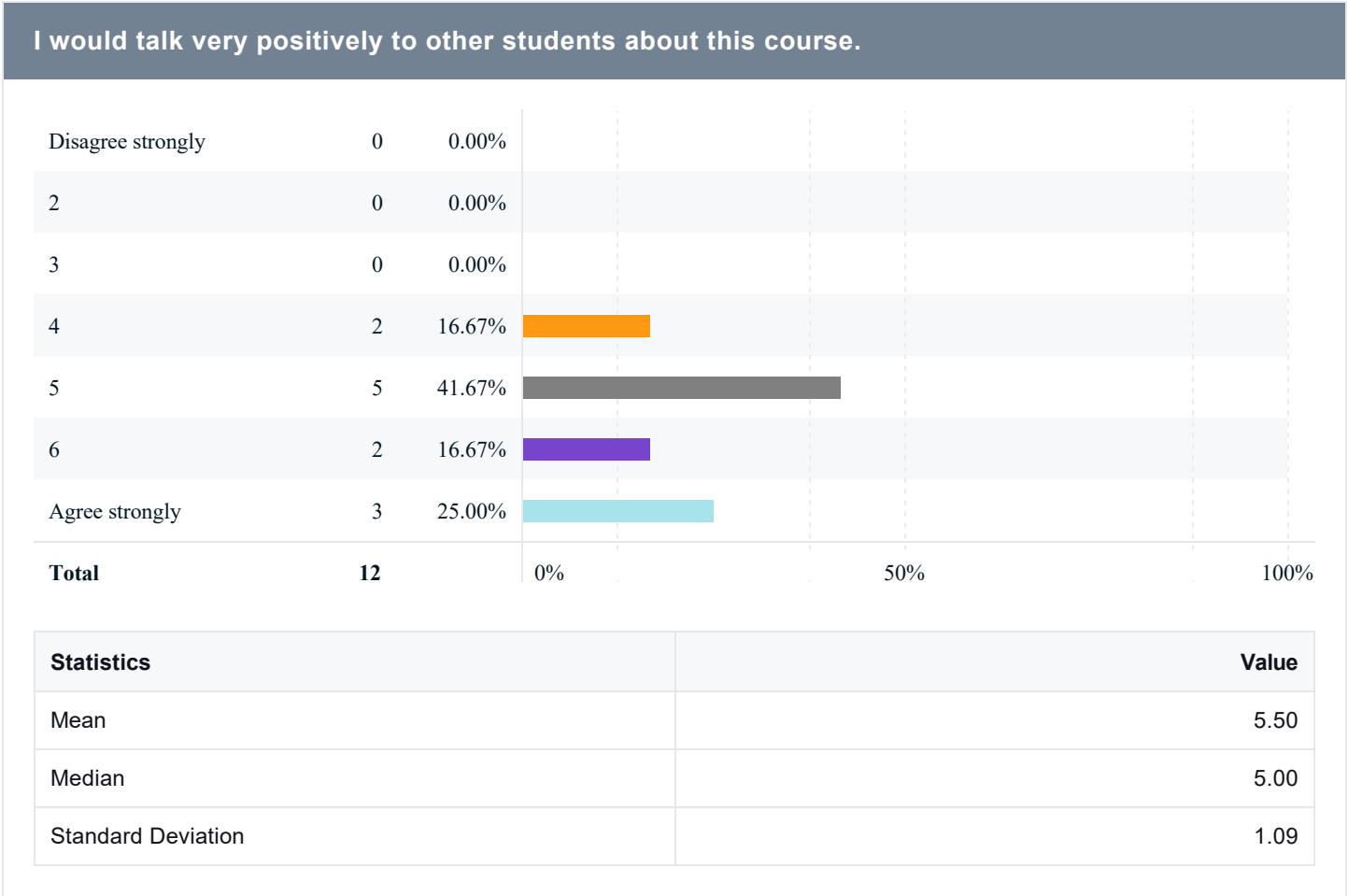
Overall, I am satisfied with the quality of this course.

Disagree strongly	0	0.00%	
2	0	0.00%	
3	0	0.00%	
4	1	8.33%	
5	4	33.33%	
6	5	41.67%	
Agree strongly	2	16.67%	
Total	12	0%	50%100%

Statistics	Value
Mean	5.67
Median	6.00
Standard Deviation	0.89

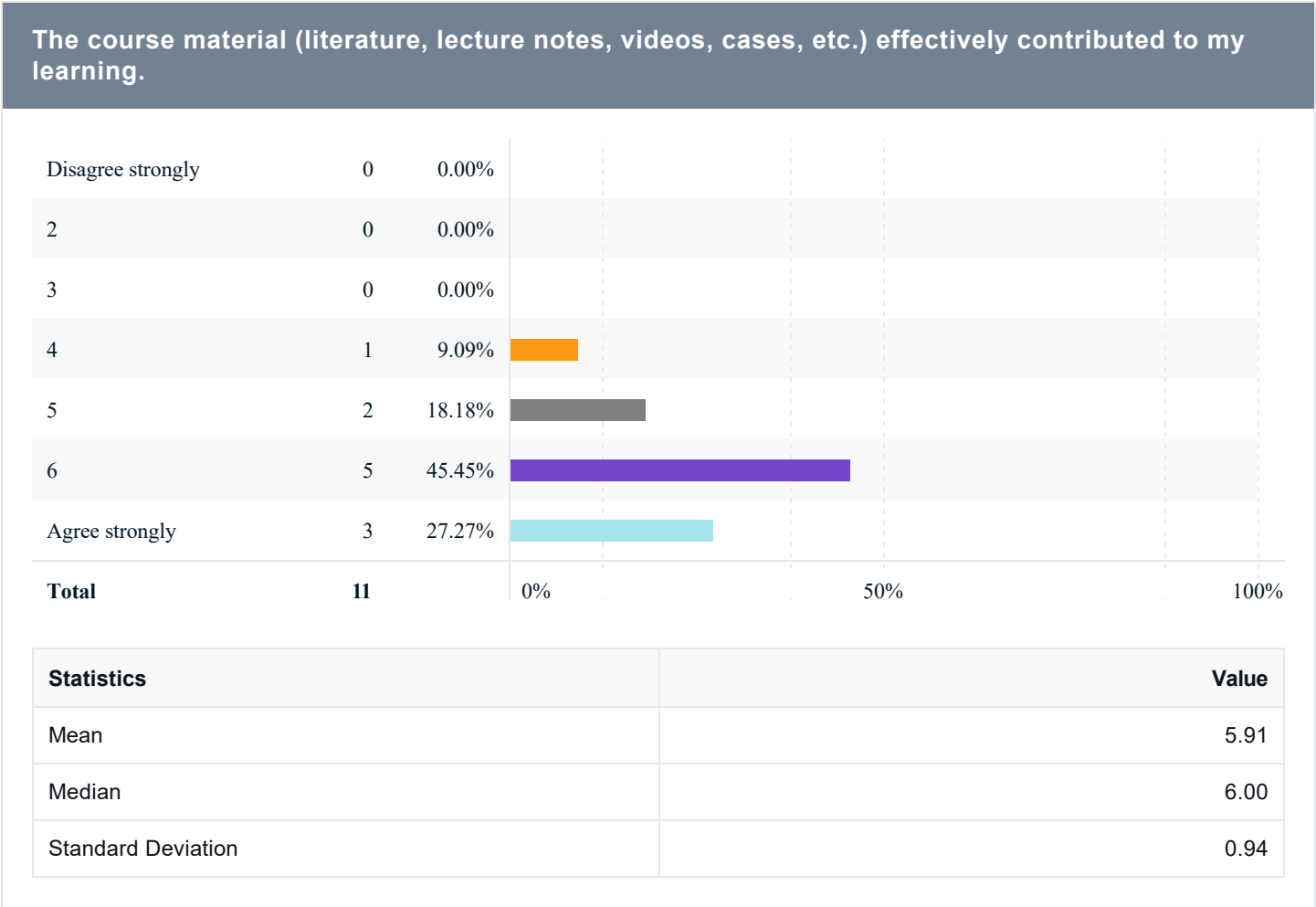
SSE Average	Mean	SD	Resp
Spring 25	5.28	1.62	973

I would talk very positively to other students about this course.



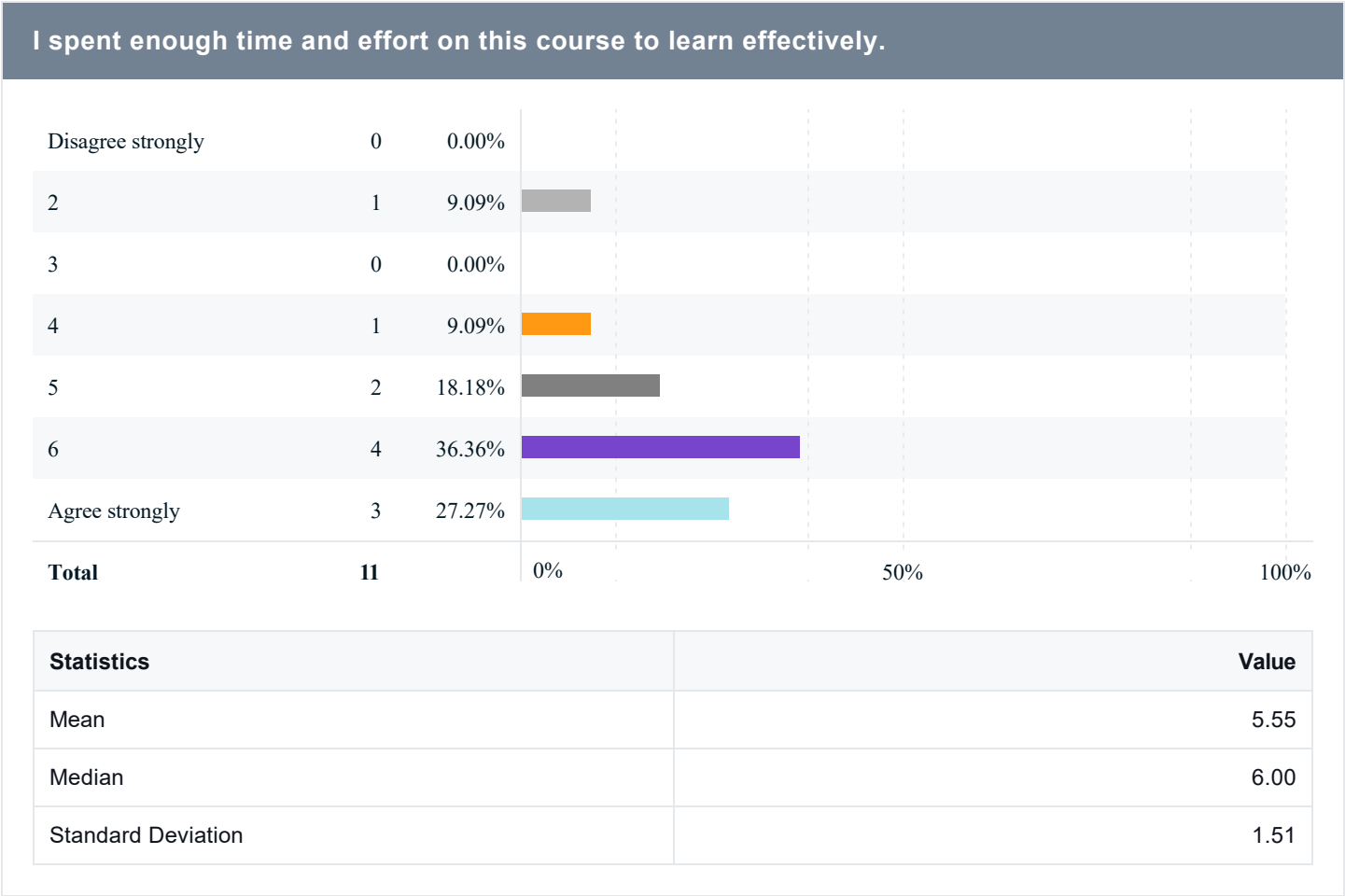
SSE Average	Mean	SD	Resp
Spring 25	5.30	1.67	931

Course Material



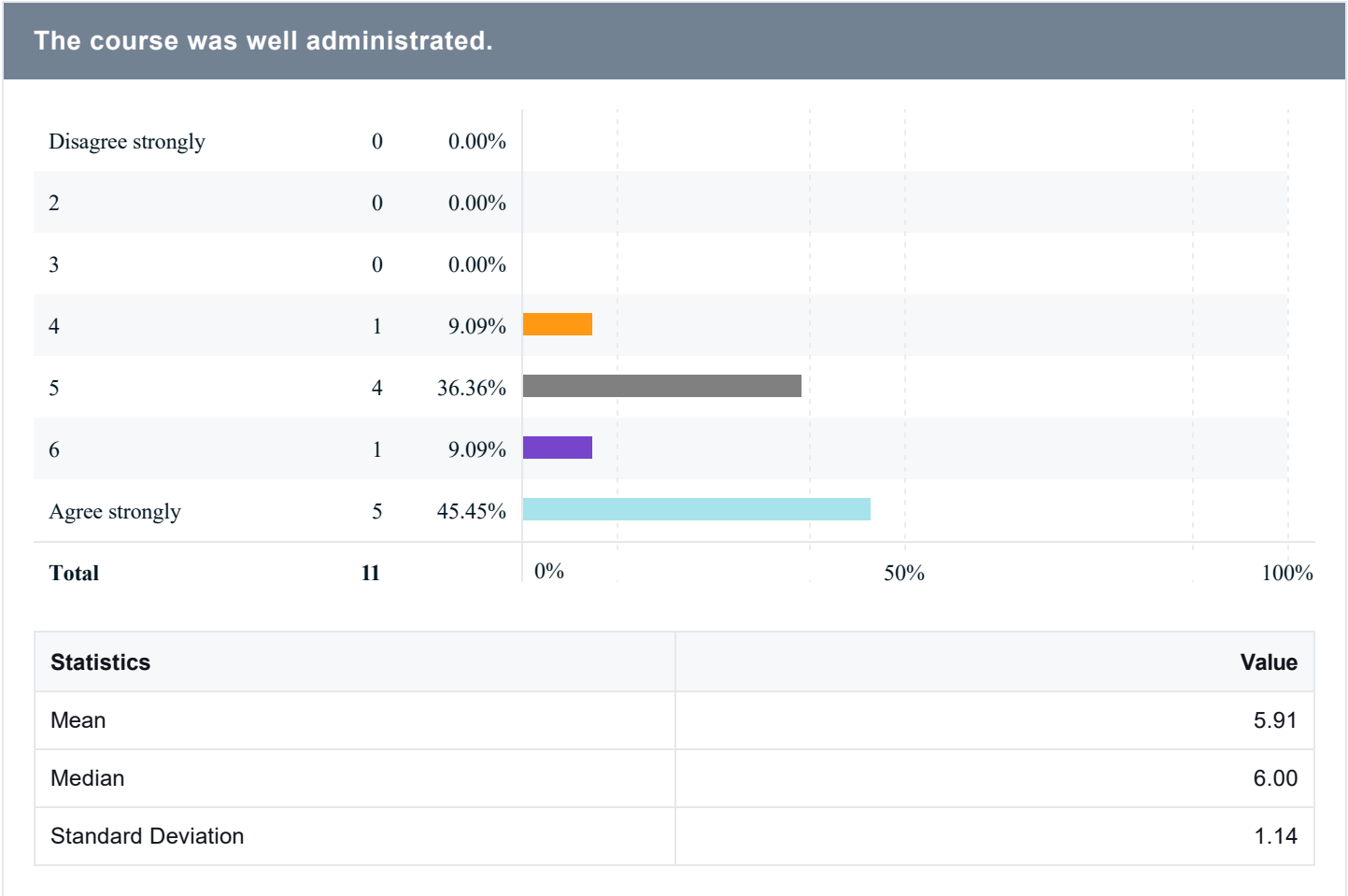
SSE Average	Mean	SD	Resp
Spring 25	5.28	1.63	932

Time Spent on Course



SSE Average	Mean	SD	Resp
Spring 25	5.59	1.34	935

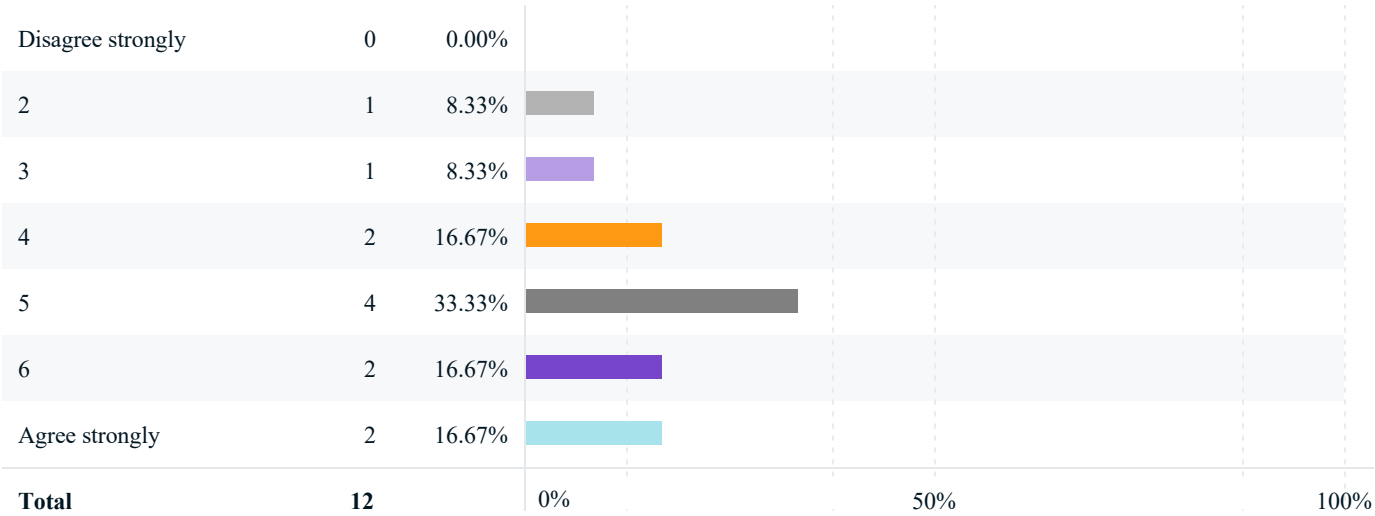
Administration



SSE Average	Mean	SD	Resp
Spring 25	5.70	1.46	926

Sustainability

This course has enhanced my understanding of how course content relates to sustainable development (e.g. environmental, social and economic aspects).



Statistics	Value
Mean	4.92
Median	5.00
Standard Deviation	1.51

SSE Average	Mean	SD	Resp
Spring 25	4.99	1.77	921

What were the strengths of this course? Please be specific and use concrete examples where possible.

Comments
Great problem sets throughout the course that reinforce what we learn in class.
Streghts is the course mix of data exercise and theory
Great material – interesting research and the lectures were surprisingly easy to follow, even though it is hard to understand the material in depth, of course. I thought Zoltan was a good teacher.
It was helpful that he marked every research paper regarding the essential portions to read and simplified certain notations in the empirical analysis carried through in the academic paper.
Julia is a fun language :)
lots of practical details on how consumption theory is actually implemented in practice, great coding assignments, attention paid to numerical methods
Focus on research in the relevant area , quantitative analysis of welfare, a good experience to learn coding

How could this course be improved? Please be specific and use concrete examples where possible.

Comments
Would be great to elaborate even more how one can by one self model in Julia to tackle inequality question. It was nice to get handed pre made models, but would been great to have session prepering one to formulate a reserch question and do general psedo code to answer it and data sources. Maybe write more one the white board to make student wrtei notes?
Perhaps it could be clearer in the slides what the main model is in the course and how we solve it. Or perhaps have lecture notes with only the model. Since it is adapted from the papers, it can be hard to follow sometimes. Perhaps a textbook like Sargent and Ljungkvist or similar could help since we didn't do a lot of infinite-horizon modelling before in the program.
The teaching seemed very fast paced, coding was a bit difficult to follow through. Could have been helpful if there was lab timings like one administered in Applied Econometric Time Series course. It was sometimes difficult to follow through his lectures
More complex intuition
Mathematical questions were too few and quite intense on the assignments, some more practise could help with us facing the exam.

What would you like to tell future students about this course?

Comments

Great practice for coding more complex models than most other courses/bachelor's degree.

Very interesting course that lets you understand some key mechanisms underlying the increase in inequality we see. If you try to connect the dots to the previous courses in MECON this will help a lot!

Teacher Questions

Q1: The teacher effectively advanced and facilitated my learning.
Q2: I received the help I needed from the teacher in an appropriate time frame.
Total: Overall of All Questions

If no tables are displayed in this section, no teacher-specific questions were included in the survey.

Teacher Zoltan Racz

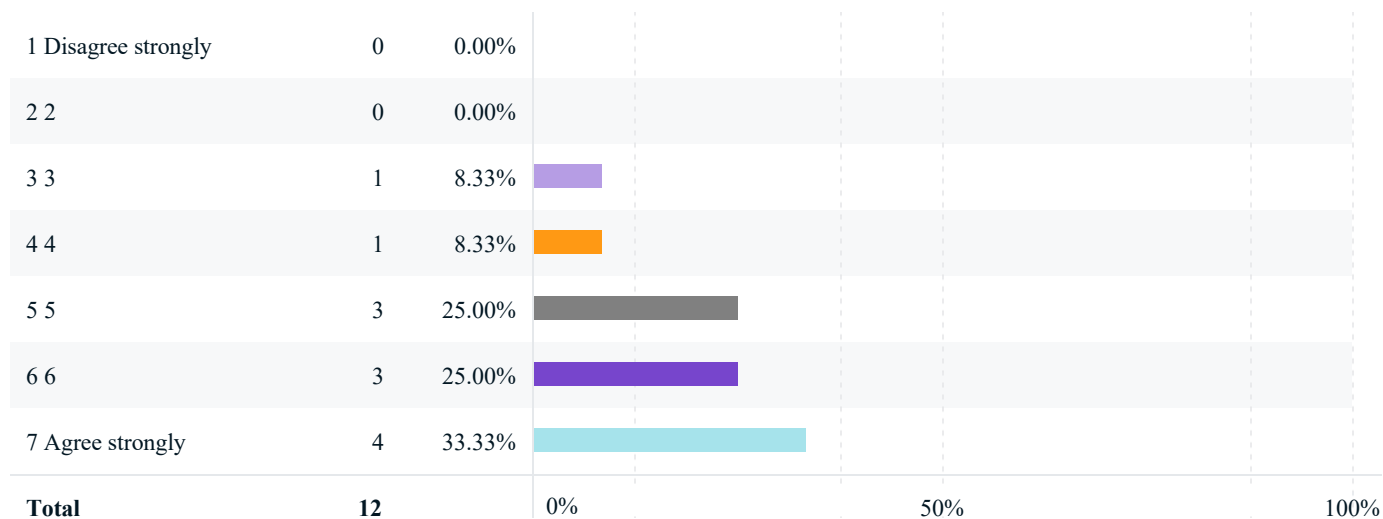
	Q1			Q2		
	Mean	SD	Resp	Mean	SD	Resp
Overall	5.92	0.79	12	6.27	0.90	11

SSE Average, current period

	Q1			Q2		
	Mean	SD	Resp	Mean	SD	Resp
Overall	5.72	1.54	1688	6.01	1.44	1455

Equality and Diversity

In this course, the teacher(s) actively worked to include different people and perspectives. This was demonstrated in, for example, the selection of course materials, case studies and/or guest speakers as well as during lectures and classroom discussions through balanced speaking time and avoiding stereotypical examples.



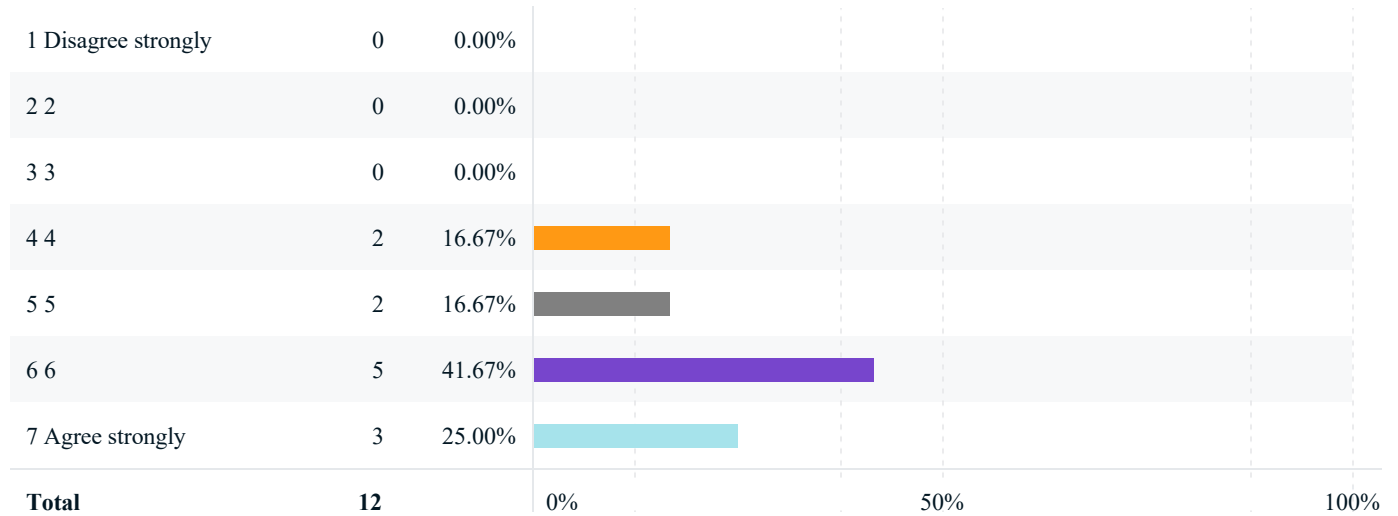
Statistics	Value
Mean	5.67
Median	6.00
Standard Deviation	1.30

SSE Average	Mean	SD	Resp
Spring 25	5.73	1.42	871

Course Questions

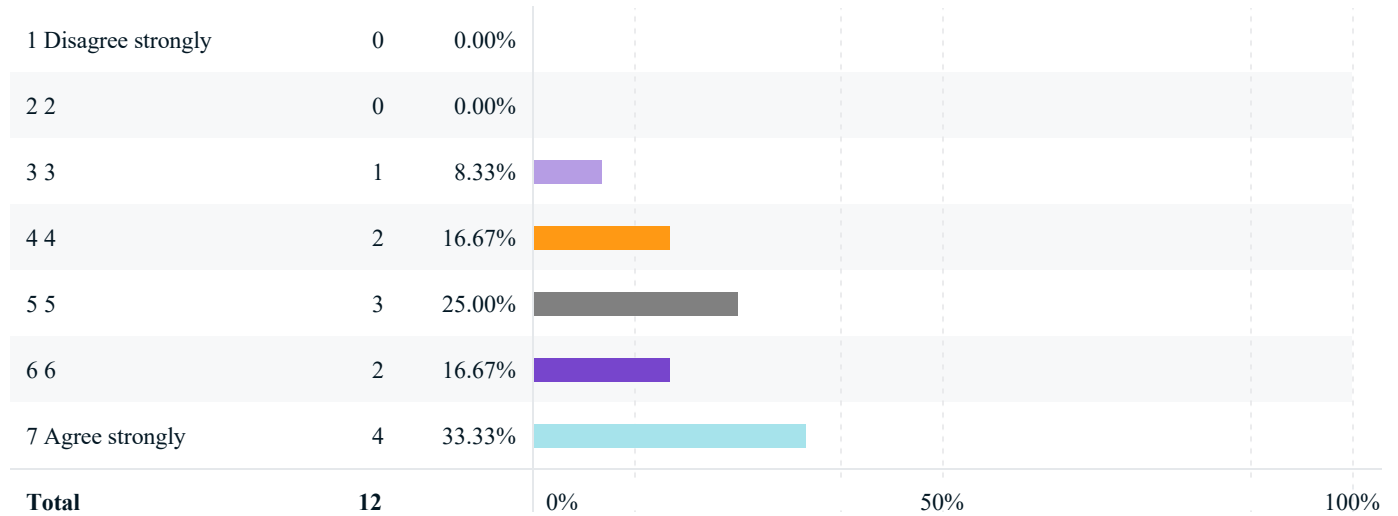


2. The course workload and requirements were appropriate for the course level.



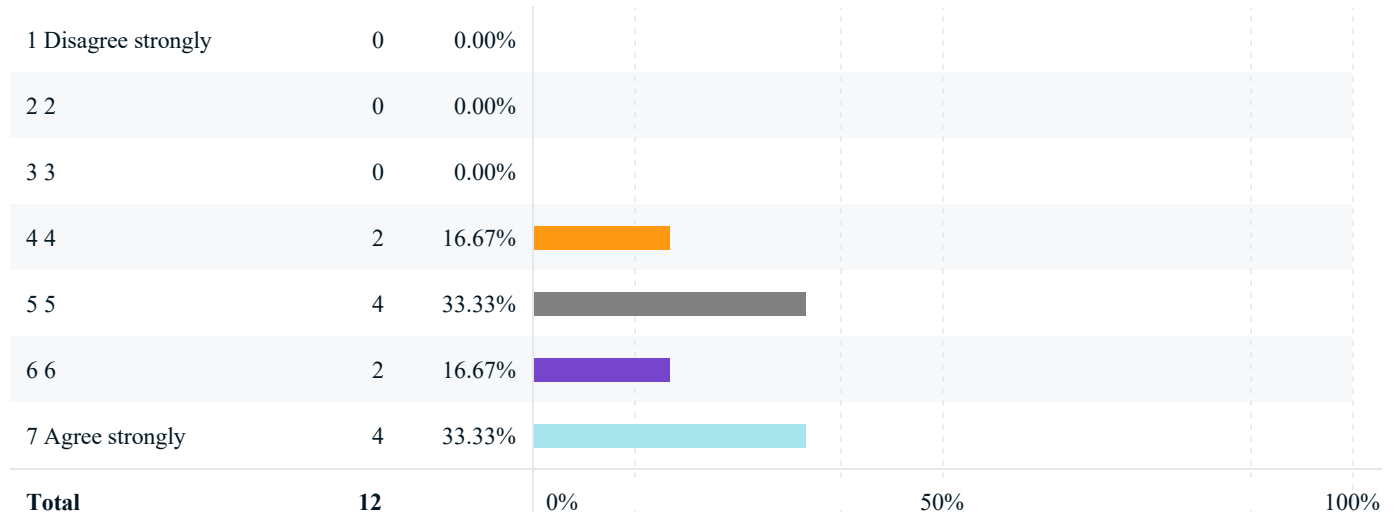
Statistics	Value
Mean	5.75
Median	6.00
Standard Deviation	1.06

3. The support my teaching assistant(s) provided contributed to my learning in the course.



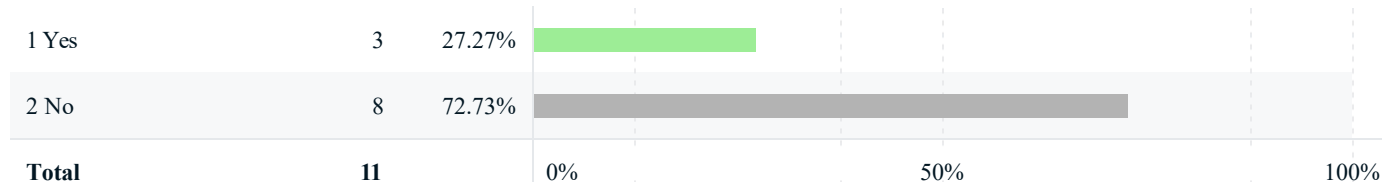
Statistics	Value
Mean	5.50
Median	5.50
Standard Deviation	1.38

4. The teaching assistant(s) was well prepared.



Statistics	Value
Mean	5.67
Median	5.50
Standard Deviation	1.15

The tempo of this course was challenging to follow.



Statistics	Value
Mean	1.73
Median	2.00
Standard Deviation	0.47

Comment
- julia
- Perhaps the Bellman equation and some of the math (like iterated expectations) we have not done so much. It could have been helpful instead of having a week of Julia to have a week revising this math and refreshing our memory on the constrained optimisation with more than two periods (since in macro we had a 2-period OLG model often).
- I would say the coding part would be difficult for students without CS background before but it is a very good and interesting part for me